Reducing hidden course costs

Have I reduced hidden course costs?

EQUITY / CURRICULUM

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

Financial barriers are minimised using library/free alternatives; unavoidable costs are flagged early

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

The same course requirement can land very differently depending on time, money, care, disability, work, housing or confidence. Equity asks whether students with different lives have a real opportunity to participate and succeed, rather than simply receiving the same rule.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “This course assumes university is the only thing happening in my life.”
- “I can technically enrol, but the way this is organised makes participation fragile.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Audit costs beyond tuition, including software, travel, printing, uniforms or materials.
- Use free or library-supported options wherever possible.
- Where costs are unavoidable, give students early notice and advice about support.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

A design subject switches from proprietary software licences to institutionally supported tools and flags material costs in the course profile.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

This course has been designed to reduce hidden costs and clearly flag unavoidable costs before students commit to the course. If you notice an avoidable barrier or an important perspective that is missing, tell us through…

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Open education

Inclusive practice